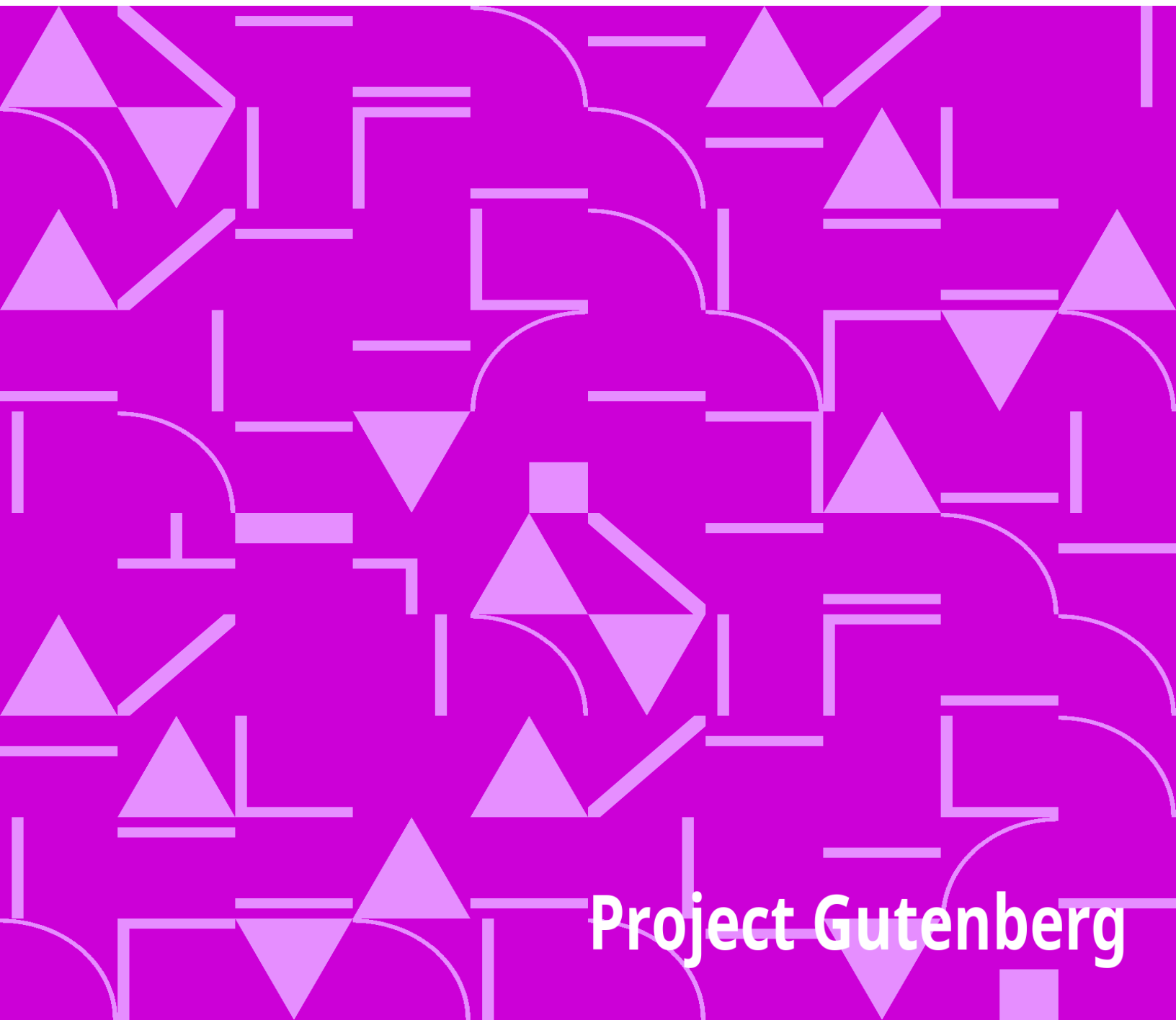


# American Historical and Literary Curiosities, Part 18.

J. Jay Smith



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J. Jay Smith

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**AMERICAN HISTORICAL  
AND  
LITERARY CURIOSITIES**

**By John Jay Smith**

# **Part 18.**

## **Second Series**

**1860**

AMERICAN  
Historical and Literary Curiosities;  
CONSISTING OF  
Fac-Similes of some Plates, &c. Relating to  
COLUMBUS,  
AND  
*ORIGINAL DOCUMENTS of the REVOLUTION,*  
*&c. &c.*

WITH A VARIETY OF RELIQUES, ANTIQUITIES, AND AUTOGRAPHS.

EDITED AND ARRANGED,  
WITH THE ASSISTANCE OF SEVERAL AUTOGRAPH COLLECTORS,

BY

JOHN JAY SMITH,  
MEMBER OF THE HISTORICAL SOCIETY OF PENNSYLVANIA, ETC.

SECOND SERIES—COMPLETE IN ITSELF.

NEW YORK:  
CHARLES B. RICHARDSON.  
1860.

*Enlarge*

## P R E F A C E.

---

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JOHN JAY SMITH.

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§§ 1



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PLATE XLV.—1. Caricature of John Randolph of Roanoke, who said in Congress if a certain bill was passed he would go to Panama; and this cut immediately appeared in Washington. *In possession of Misses E. C. and M. H. Morris.*

2. Letter from John Randolph to John McAllister, respecting his Spectacles, &c. *In possession of John McAllister.*

PLATE XLVI.—1. One of Dr. Franklin's original Electrical Machines. *Preserved in the Germantown Academy, Pennsylvania.*

2. Two Letters of Dr. Franklin to his Wife, beginning, "My dear child." *In possession of Ferdinand J. Dreer.*

PLATE XLVII.—1. Communion Plate presented to Christ's Church, Philadelphia, in 1708, by Queen Anne; with the inscription. *In possession of the Church.*

2. Certificate of the membership of Charles Cist to the Society for the Institution of First Day or Sunday Schools of the City of Philadelphia, signed by Bishop White in 1791. *In possession of Lewis J. Cist.*

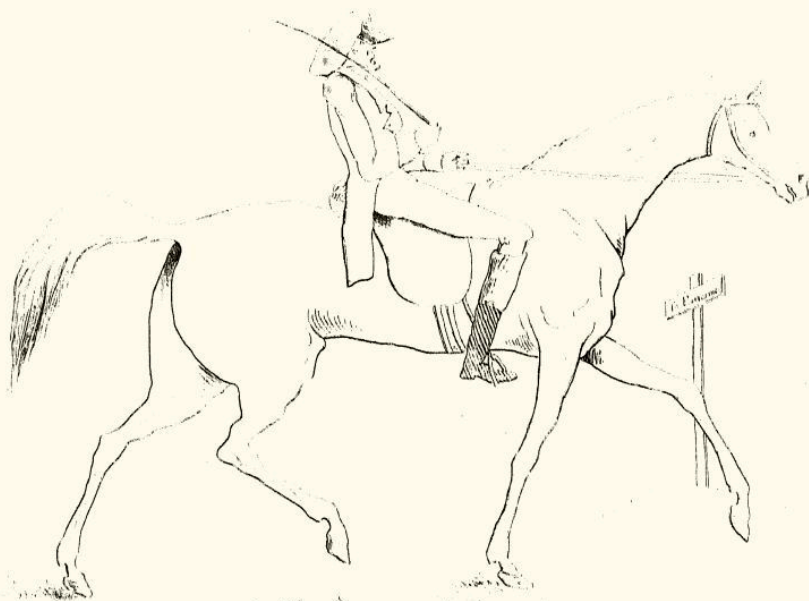
PLATE XLVIII.—Letter from Baron Humboldt, addressed to Theodore S. Fay, Chargé d'Affaires at Berlin, respecting the Exposition coming to the United States, &c. With a Fac-simile of the Envelop and Seal. *In possession of J. Jay Smith.*

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[Plate 46.](#)

[Plate 47.](#)

[Plate 48.](#)



Caricature of Jno. Randolph going to Panama.

Sir

oaklands, on Elk Ridge  
Anne Arundel County  
Maryland April 4. 1820.

Within you have Mr Oth's. & Mr Lamb's receipts  
for the four pair of Spectacles, also a N. T. five dollar  
note for the Purveyors that I let Mr Mercer have.  
If he still have paid for them please to <sup>return</sup> the note  
enclosed to me under cover addressed as usual. Otherwise  
pay it to my final credit & return Mr. his note when  
rec<sup>d</sup> stating the fact & date of my payment.

Your Obedt Serv<sup>t</sup>?

J. R. of Roanoke

Mr John McAlister

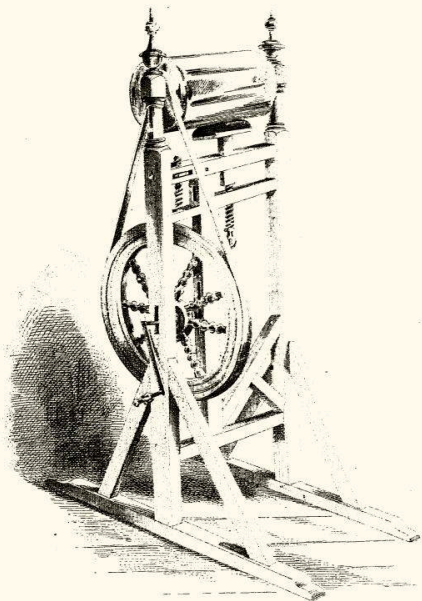
48 Chesnut Str.

Philada.

Tuesday Morning, new laid eggs,  
<sup>close</sup> in a house frozen layt right into  
solid blocks of ice to the centre.

N. B Your letter was not rec<sup>d</sup> until I was in my carriage to  
come here. The green glasses with I think almost restore my eyes.  
I can see better with 36 than I could before with any number, but  
send with the asked eye Whistly will unless the first be very bad.  
I see little difference between the effect of the Purveyors & the same  
green glasses.

Enlarge



Franklin's original Electric Machine.

Two letters to his Wife  
beginning My dear Child!

My dear Child,

By Capt Falconer, I shall write to you  
fully; this only serves to acquaint you  
that I am as well as I can be without  
my usual journey, but I begin to feel  
the want of it, and shall set out in a  
few days, for a Tour of a few Weeks.  
I hope you are perfectly recovered. My  
Love to Sally, & all Friends. I am,  
as ever

London, July 5 1789  
Your affectionate Husband  
B Franklin

My dear Child,

Wickham, the seat of  
Lord de Despenier, Bucks.  
July 6. 1773. -

I am here in my way to Oxford, where  
I am going to be present at the Installation,  
& shall stay a few Days among my Friends there.  
By Capt. All who sails next Week I shall write  
fully to you, & to Friends in Philadelphia.  
This is my only Letter of Packet. Love to our  
Children, & to Benny Boy. I am, Thanks  
to God, very well and hearty, and ever

Your affectionate Husband  
B Franklin

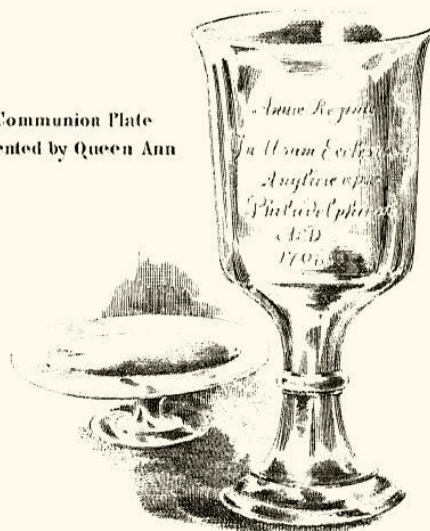
P. XVI.

Enlarge



Communion Plate  
presented by Queen Ann

to Christ's Church  
Philadelphia.



Philadelphia April 6<sup>th</sup> 1791.

Charles Cist, having subscribed the Constitution of the  
Society for the Institution and Support of First Day & Sunday Schools in the City  
of Philadelphia, and the Districts of Southwark and the Northern Liberties,  
and paid into the hands of their Treasurer the sum of ONE DOLLAR, is entitled  
to Membership in the said society during his annual contribution of said sum

Signed by Order of the Society  
Wm. White President



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NEW YORK:  
CHARLES B. RICHARDSON.  
1860.

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## PREFACE.

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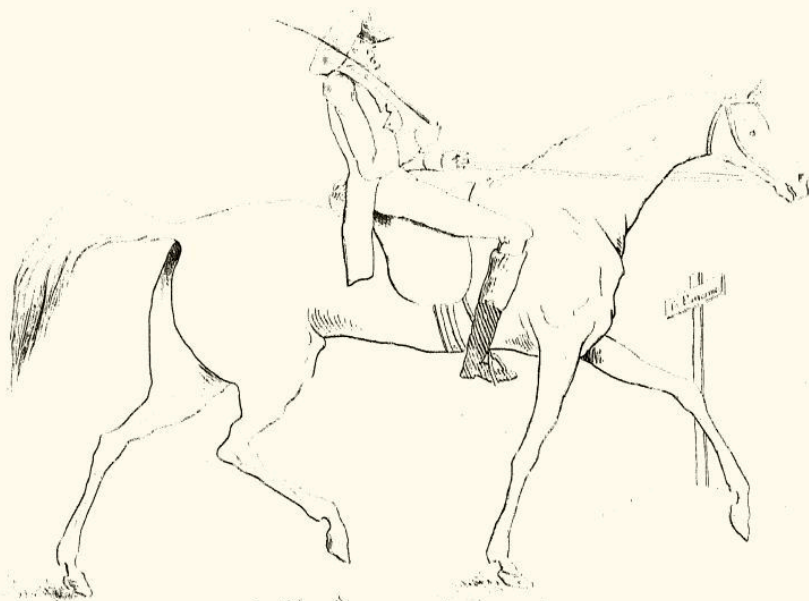
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JOHN JAY SMITH.

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Caricature of Jno. Randolph going to Panama.

Sir

Oaklands, on Elk Ridge  
Anne Arundel County  
Maryland April 4. 1820.

Within you have Mr Ott's. & Mr Lamb's receipts  
for the four pair of Spectacles, also a N. T. five dollar  
note for the Parityers that I let Mr Mercer have.  
If he shall have paid for them please to <sup>return</sup> the note  
enclosed to me under cover addressed as usual. Otherwise  
pay it to my final credit & return Mr. his note when  
rec<sup>d</sup> stating the fact & date of my payment.

Your Obedt Serv<sup>t</sup>?

J. R. of Roanoke

Mr John McAlister

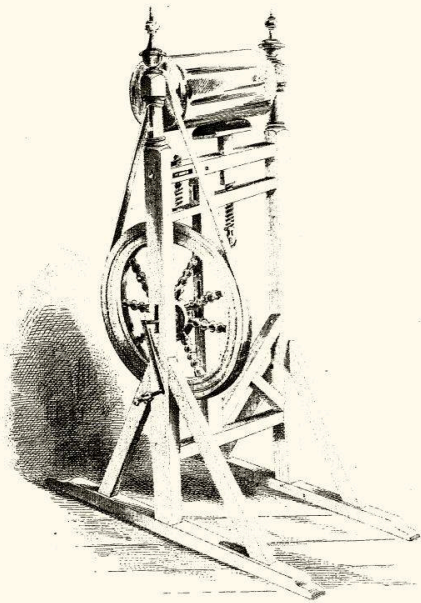
48 Chesnut Str.

Philadelphia.

Tuesday Morning, new laid eggs,  
<sup>close</sup> in a house frozen layt right into  
solid blocks of ice to the centre.

N. B Your letter was not rec<sup>d</sup> until I was in my carriage to  
come here. The green glasses with I think almost restore my eyes.  
I can see better with 36 than I could before with any number. but  
send with the asked eye Wholly will unless the first be very bad.  
I see little difference between the effect of the Parityers & the flame  
green glasses.

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Franklin's original Electric Machine.

Two letters to his Wife  
beginning *My dear Child!*

*My dear Child,*

By Capt Talbot, I shall write to you  
fully; this only serves to acquaint you  
that I am as well as I can be without  
my usual Journey, but I begin to feel  
the want of it, and shall set out in a  
few days, for a Tour of a few Weeks.  
I hope you are perfectly recovered. My  
Love to Sally, & all Friends. I am,  
as ever

London, July 5  
1773

Your affectionate Husband  
B. Franklin

*My dear Child,*

Mr Wickham, the Seat of  
Lord de Despenier, Bucks.  
July 6. 1773. -

I am here in my way to Oxford, where  
I am going to be present at the Installation,  
& shall stay a few Days among my Friends there.  
By Capt. All who sail next Week I shall write  
fully to you, & to Friends in Philadelphia.  
This is my only Letter of Packet. Love to our  
Children, & to Benny Boy. I am, Thanks  
to God, very well and hearty, and ever

Your affectionate Husband  
B. Franklin

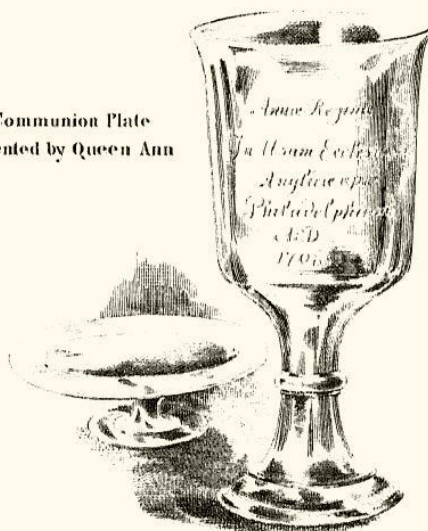
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Communion Plate  
presented by Queen Ann

to Christ's Church  
Philadelphia.



Philadelphia April 6<sup>th</sup> 1791.

Charles Coit, having subscribed the Constitution of the  
Society for the Institution and Support of First Day & Sunday Schools in the City  
of Philadelphia, and the Districts of Southwark and the Northern Liberties,  
and paid into the hands of their Treasurer the sum of ONE DOLLAR, is entitled  
to Membership in the said society during his annual contribution of said sum  
Signed by Order of the Society  
Wm. White President

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Translation

I have to offer you many thanks for your kind & interesting communications, my dear Sir, particularly for the translation, which arrived very acceptably. It is a very happy idea to transport the objects of the exposition to the United States. It will give one much pleasure to receive Mr. Smith at 1 o'clock on Friday, if this hour is not inconvenient to him. Mr. Dana is without doubt the able zoologist who has made the voyage round the world & written upon corals; but alas! I lose myself in my English, what is this word mistake on the last page and the two years before the Mast, before one has eaten of gland?

Thousands friendships - The Peace Society, and your compatriot Saint Elmer Burrell will give us peace with Austria I hope

Rotterdam Wednesday.

B. V. Humboldt.

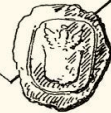
J'ai a vous remercier mille et mille fois pour la traduction que vous m'avez envoyee. Elle est arrivee a bon port et avec beaucoup de plaisir. C'est une tres bonne idee de transporter les objets de l'exposition aux Etats Unis. On aura beaucoup de plaisir a recevoir M. Smith a 1 heure le vendredi, si cette heure n'est pas inconveniente pour lui. M. Dana est sans doute le zele zoologiste qui a fait le voyage autour du monde et qui a ecrit sur les coraux; mais hélas! je me perds dans mon anglais, quelle est cette faute de mot sur la dernière page et les deux ans avant le mât, avant qu'on ait mangé de la gland?

The King has been surprised in the Illustrated Times at a project of a monument to the honor of Washington, a naked obelisk 600 feet high! is this seriously intended?

Humboldt  
a Paris  
le 15 Mars  
à M. S. Fay  
Chargé d'affaires  
à Berlin  
J'ai le plaisir de vous remercier de la traduction que vous m'avez envoyée. Elle est arrivée à bon port et avec beaucoup de plaisir. C'est une très bonne idée de transporter les objets de l'exposition aux États Unis. On aura beaucoup de plaisir à recevoir M. Smith à 1 heure le vendredi, si cette heure n'est pas inconveniente pour lui. M. Dana est sans doute le zele zoologiste qui a fait le voyage autour du monde et qui a écrit sur les coraux; mais hélas! je me perds dans mon anglais, quelle est cette faute de mot sur la dernière page et les deux ans avant le mât, avant qu'on ait mangé de la gland?

M. S. Fay  
Chargé d'affaires  
à Berlin

Humboldt



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Note from Baron Humboldt to Theodore S. Fay, Chargé d'affaires at Berlin.

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